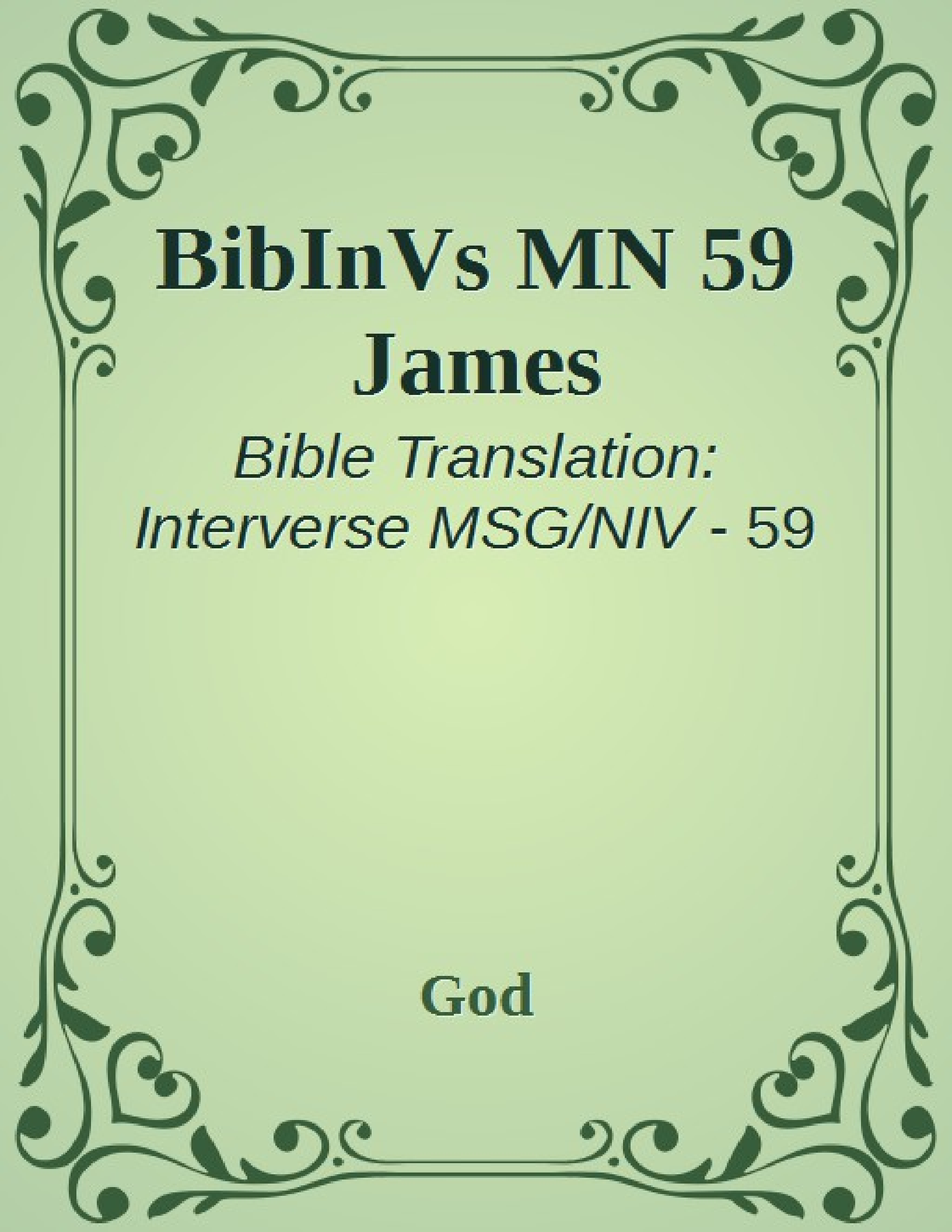


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

**BibInVs MN 59**

**James**

*Bible Translation:  
Interverse MSG/NIV - 59*

**God**

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# Interversed Message/NIV Bible

## James

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### James 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 I, James, am a slave of God and the Master Jesus, writing to the twelve tribes scattered to Kingdom Come: Hello!
- 1 James, a servant of God and of the Lord Jesus Christ, To the twelve tribes scattered among the nations: Greetings.
- 2 Consider it a sheer gift, friends, when tests and challenges come at you from all sides.
- 2 Consider it pure joy, my brothers, whenever you face trials of many kinds,
- 3 You know that under pressure, your faith-life is forced into the open and shows its true colors.
- 3 because you know that the testing of your faith develops perseverance.
- 4 So don't try to get out of anything prematurely. Let it do its work so you become mature and well-developed, not deficient in any way.
- 4 Perseverance must finish its work so that you may be mature and complete, not lacking anything.
- 5 If you don't know what you're doing, pray to the Father. He loves to help. You'll get his help, and won't be condescended to when you ask for it.
- 5 If any of you lacks wisdom, he should ask God, who gives generously to all without finding fault, and it will be given to him.
- 6 Ask boldly, believingly, without a second thought. People who "worry their prayers" are like wind-whipped waves.
- 6 But when he asks, he must believe and not doubt, because he who doubts is like a wave of the sea, blown and tossed by the wind.
- 7 Don't think you're going to get anything from the Master that way,
- 7 That man should not think he will receive anything from the Lord;
- 8 adrift at sea, keeping all your options open.
- 8 he is a double-minded man, unstable in all he does.

- 9 When down-and-outers get a break, cheer!
- 9 The brother in humble circumstances ought to take pride in his high position.
- 10 And when the arrogant rich are brought down to size, cheer! Prosperity is as short-lived as a wildflower, so don't ever count on it.
- 10 But the one who is rich should take pride in his low position, because he will pass away like a wild flower.
- 11 You know that as soon as the sun rises, pouring down its scorching heat, the flower withers. Its petals wilt and, before you know it, that beautiful face is a barren stem. Well, that's a picture of the "prosperous life." At the very moment everyone is looking on in admiration, it fades away to nothing.
- 11 For the sun rises with scorching heat and withers the plant; its blossom falls and its beauty is destroyed. In the same way, the rich man will fade away even while he goes about his business.
- 12 Anyone who meets a testing challenge head-on and manages to stick it out is mighty fortunate. For such persons loyally in love with God, the reward is life and more life.
- 12 Blessed is the man who perseveres under trial, because when he has stood the test, he will receive the crown of life that God has promised to those who love him.
- 13 Don't let anyone under pressure to give in to evil say, "God is trying to trip me up." God is impervious to evil, and puts evil in no one's way.
- 13 When tempted, no one should say, "God is tempting me." For God cannot be tempted by evil, nor does he tempt anyone;
- 14 The temptation to give in to evil comes from us and only us. We have no one to blame but the leering, seducing flare-up of our own lust.
- 14 but each one is tempted when, by his own evil desire, he is dragged away and enticed.
- 15 Lust gets pregnant, and has a baby: sin! Sin grows up to adulthood, and becomes a real killer.
- 15 Then, after desire has conceived, it gives birth to sin; and sin, when it is full-grown, gives birth to death.
- 16 So, my very dear friends, don't get thrown off course.
- 16 Don't be deceived, my dear brothers.

- 17 Every desirable and beneficial gift comes out of heaven. The gifts are rivers of light cascading down from the Father of Light. There is nothing deceitful in God, nothing two-faced, nothing fickle.
- 17 Every good and perfect gift is from above, coming down from the Father of the heavenly lights, who does not change like shifting shadows.
- 18 He brought us to life using the true Word, showing us off as the crown of all his creatures.
- 18 He chose to give us birth through the word of truth, that we might be a kind of firstfruits of all he created.
- 19 Post this at all the intersections, dear friends: Lead with your ears, follow up with your tongue, and let anger straggle along in the rear.
- 19 My dear brothers, take note of this: Everyone should be quick to listen, slow to speak and slow to become angry,
- 20 God's righteousness doesn't grow from human anger.
- 20 for man's anger does not bring about the righteous life that God desires.
- 21 So throw all spoiled virtue and cancerous evil in the garbage. In simple humility, let our gardener, God, landscape you with the Word, making a salvation-garden of your life.
- 21 Therefore, get rid of all moral filth and the evil that is so prevalent and humbly accept the word planted in you, which can save you.
- 22 Don't fool yourself into thinking that you are a listener when you are anything but, letting the Word go in one ear and out the other. Act on what you hear!
- 22 Do not merely listen to the word, and so deceive yourselves. Do what it says.
- 23 Those who hear and don't act are like those who glance in the mirror,
- 23 Anyone who listens to the word but does not do what it says is like a man who looks at his face in a mirror
- 24 walk away, and two minutes later have no idea who they are, what they look like.
- 24 and, after looking at himself, goes away and immediately forgets what he looks like.
- 25 But whoever catches a glimpse of the revealed counsel of God--the free life!--even out of the corner of his eye, and sticks with it, is no distracted

scatterbrain but a man or woman of action. That person will find delight and affirmation in the action.

25 But the man who looks intently into the perfect law that gives freedom, and continues to do this, not forgetting what he has heard, but doing it-- he will be blessed in what he does.

26 Anyone who sets himself up as "religious" by talking a good game is self-deceived. This kind of religion is hot air and only hot air.

26 If anyone considers himself religious and yet does not keep a tight rein on his tongue, he deceives himself and his religion is worthless.

27 Real religion, the kind that passes muster before God the Father, is this: Reach out to the homeless and loveless in their plight, and guard against corruption from the godless world.

27 Religion that God our Father accepts as pure and faultless is this: to look after orphans and widows in their distress and to keep oneself from being polluted by the world.

## James 2

MSG

NIV

1 My dear friends, don't let public opinion influence how you live out our glorious, Christ-originated faith.

1 My brothers, as believers in our glorious Lord Jesus Christ, don't show favoritism.

2 If a man enters your church wearing an expensive suit, and a street person wearing rags comes in right after him,

2 Suppose a man comes into your meeting wearing a gold ring and fine clothes, and a poor man in shabby clothes also comes in.

3 and you say to the man in the suit, "Sit here, sir; this is the best seat in the house!" and either ignore the street person or say, "Better sit here in the back row,"

3 If you show special attention to the man wearing fine clothes and say, "Here's a good seat for you," but say to the poor man, "You stand there" or "Sit on the floor by my feet,"

4 haven't you segregated God's children and proved that you are judges who can't be trusted?

- 4 have you not discriminated among yourselves and become judges with evil thoughts?
- 5 Listen, dear friends. Isn't it clear by now that God operates quite differently? He chose the world's down-and-out as the kingdom's first citizens, with full rights and privileges. This kingdom is promised to anyone who loves God.
- 5 Listen, my dear brothers: Has not God chosen those who are poor in the eyes of the world to be rich in faith and to inherit the kingdom he promised those who love him?
- 6 And here you are abusing these same citizens! Isn't it the high and mighty who exploit you, who use the courts to rob you blind?
- 6 But you have insulted the poor. Is it not the rich who are exploiting you? Are they not the ones who are dragging you into court?
- 7 Aren't they the ones who scorn the new name--"Christian"--used in your baptisms?
- 7 Are they not the ones who are slandering the noble name of him to whom you belong?
- 8 You do well when you complete the Royal Rule of the Scriptures: "Love others as you love yourself."
- 8 If you really keep the royal law found in Scripture, "Love your neighbor as yourself," you are doing right.
- 9 But if you play up to these so-called important people, you go against the Rule and stand convicted by it.
- 9 But if you show favoritism, you sin and are convicted by the law as lawbreakers.
- 10 You can't pick and choose in these things, specializing in keeping one or two things in God's law and ignoring others.
- 10 For whoever keeps the whole law and yet stumbles at just one point is guilty of breaking all of it.
- 11 The same God who said, "Don't commit adultery," also said, "Don't murder." If you don't commit adultery but go ahead and murder, do you think your non-adultery will cancel out your murder? No, you're a murderer, period.
- 11 For he who said, "Do not commit adultery," also said, "Do not murder." If you do not commit adultery but do commit murder, you have become a lawbreaker.

- 12 Talk and act like a person expecting to be judged by the Rule that sets us free.
- 12 Speak and act as those who are going to be judged by the law that gives freedom,
- 13 For if you refuse to act kindly, you can hardly expect to be treated kindly. Kind mercy wins over harsh judgment every time.
- 13 because judgment without mercy will be shown to anyone who has not been merciful. Mercy triumphs over judgment!
- 14 Dear friends, do you think you'll get anywhere in this if you learn all the right words but never do anything? Does merely talking about faith indicate that a person really has it?
- 14 What good is it, my brothers, if a man claims to have faith but has no deeds? Can such faith save him?
- 15 For instance, you come upon an old friend dressed in rags and half-starved
- 15 Suppose a brother or sister is without clothes and daily food.
- 16 and say, "Good morning, friend! Be clothed in Christ! Be filled with the Holy Spirit!" and walk off without providing so much as a coat or a cup of soup--where does that get you?
- 16 If one of you says to him, "Go, I wish you well; keep warm and well fed," but does nothing about his physical needs, what good is it?
- 17 Isn't it obvious that God-talk without God-acts is outrageous nonsense?
- 17 In the same way, faith by itself, if it is not accompanied by action, is dead.
- 18 I can already hear one of you agreeing by saying, "Sounds good. You take care of the faith department, I'll handle the works department." Not so fast. You can no more show me your works apart from your faith than I can show you my faith apart from my works. Faith and works, works and faith, fit together hand in glove.
- 18 But someone will say, "You have faith; I have deeds." Show me your faith without deeds, and I will show you my faith by what I do.
- 19 Do I hear you professing to believe in the one and only God, but then observe you complacently sitting back as if you had done something wonderful? That's just great. Demons do that, but what good does it do them?



- 19 You believe that there is one God. Good! Even the demons believe that--and shudder.
- 20 Use your heads! Do you suppose for a minute that you can cut faith and works in two and not end up with a corpse on your hands?
- 20 You foolish man, do you want evidence that faith without deeds is useless?
- 21 Wasn't our ancestor Abraham "made right with God by works" when he placed his son Isaac on the sacrificial altar?
- 21 Was not our ancestor Abraham considered righteous for what he did when he offered his son Isaac on the altar?
- 22 Isn't it obvious that faith and works are yoked partners, that faith expresses itself in works? That the works are "works of faith"?
- 22 You see that his faith and his actions were working together, and his faith was made complete by what he did.
- 23 The full meaning of "believe" in the Scripture sentence, "Abraham believed God and was set right with God," includes his action. It's that mesh of believing and acting that got Abraham named "God's friend."
- 23 And the scripture was fulfilled that says, "Abraham believed God, and it was credited to him as righteousness," and he was called God's friend.
- 24 Is it not evident that a person is made right with God not by a barren faith but by faith fruitful in works?
- 24 You see that a person is justified by what he does and not by faith alone.
- 25 The same with Rahab, the Jericho harlot. Wasn't her action in hiding God's spies and helping them escape--that seamless unity of believing and doing--what counted with God?
- 25 In the same way, was not even Rahab the prostitute considered righteous for what she did when she gave lodging to the spies and sent them off in a different direction?
- 26 The very moment you separate body and spirit, you end up with a corpse. Separate faith and works and you get the same thing: a corpse.
- 26 As the body without the spirit is dead, so faith without deeds is dead.

## **James 3**

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't be in any rush to become a teacher, my friends. Teaching is highly responsible work. Teachers are held to the strictest standards.
- 1 Not many of you should presume to be teachers, my brothers, because you know that we who teach will be judged more strictly.
- 2 And none of us is perfectly qualified. We get it wrong nearly every time we open our mouths. If you could find someone whose speech was perfectly true, you'd have a perfect person, in perfect control of life.
- 2 We all stumble in many ways. If anyone is never at fault in what he says, he is a perfect man, able to keep his whole body in check.
- 3 A bit in the mouth of a horse controls the whole horse.
- 3 When we put bits into the mouths of horses to make them obey us, we can turn the whole animal.
- 4 A small rudder on a huge ship in the hands of a skilled captain sets a course in the face of the strongest winds.
- 4 Or take ships as an example. Although they are so large and are driven by strong winds, they are steered by a very small rudder wherever the pilot wants to go.
- 5 A word out of your mouth may seem of no account, but it can accomplish nearly anything--or destroy it! It only takes a spark, remember, to set off a forest fire.
- 5 Likewise the tongue is a small part of the body, but it makes great boasts. Consider what a great forest is set on fire by a small spark.
- 6 A careless or wrongly placed word out of your mouth can do that. By our speech we can ruin the world, turn harmony to chaos, throw mud on a reputation, send the whole world up in smoke and go up in smoke with it, smoke right from the pit of hell.
- 6 The tongue also is a fire, a world of evil among the parts of the body. It corrupts the whole person, sets the whole course of his life on fire, and is itself set on fire by hell.
- 7 This is scary: You can tame a tiger,
- 7 All kinds of animals, birds, reptiles and creatures of the sea are being tamed and have been tamed by man,
- 8 but you can't tame a tongue--it's never been done. The tongue runs wild, a wanton killer.
- 8 but no man can tame the tongue. It is a restless evil, full of deadly poison.

- 9 With our tongues we bless God our Father; with the same tongues we curse the very men and women he made in his image.
- 9 With the tongue we praise our Lord and Father, and with it we curse men, who have been made in God's likeness.
- 10 Curses and blessings out of the same mouth! My friends, this can't go on.
- 10 Out of the same mouth come praise and cursing. My brothers, this should not be.
- 11 A spring doesn't gush fresh water one day and brackish the next, does it?
- 11 Can both fresh water and salt water flow from the same spring?
- 12 Apple trees don't bear strawberries, do they? Raspberry bushes don't bear apples, do they? You're not going to dip into a polluted mud hole and get a cup of clear, cool water, are you?
- 12 My brothers, can a fig tree bear olives, or a grapevine bear figs? Neither can a salt spring produce fresh water.
- 13 Do you want to be counted wise, to build a reputation for wisdom? Here's what you do: Live well, live wisely, live humbly. It's the way you live, not the way you talk, that counts.
- 13 Who is wise and understanding among you? Let him show it by his good life, by deeds done in the humility that comes from wisdom.
- 14 Mean-spirited ambition isn't wisdom. Boasting that you are wise isn't wisdom. Twisting the truth to make yourselves sound wise isn't wisdom.
- 14 But if you harbor bitter envy and selfish ambition in your hearts, do not boast about it or deny the truth.
- 15 It's the furthest thing from wisdom--it's animal cunning, devilish conniving.
- 15 Such "wisdom" does not come down from heaven but is earthly, unspiritual, of the devil.
- 16 Whenever you're trying to look better than others or get the better of others, things fall apart and everyone ends up at the others' throats.
- 16 For where you have envy and selfish ambition, there you find disorder and every evil practice.
- 17 Real wisdom, God's wisdom, begins with a holy life and is characterized by getting along with others. It is gentle and reasonable,

overflowing with mercy and blessings, not hot one day and cold the next, not two-faced.

- 17 But the wisdom that comes from heaven is first of all pure; then peace-loving, considerate, submissive, full of mercy and good fruit, impartial and sincere.
- 18 You can develop a healthy, robust community that lives right with God and enjoy its results only if you do the hard work of getting along with each other, treating each other with dignity and honor.
- 18 Peacemakers who sow in peace raise a harvest of righteousness.

## **James 4**

MSG

NIV

- 1 Where do you think all these appalling wars and quarrels come from? Do you think they just happen? Think again. They come about because you want your own way, and fight for it deep inside yourselves.
- 1 What causes fights and quarrels among you? Don't they come from your desires that battle within you?
- 2 You lust for what you don't have and are willing to kill to get it. You want what isn't yours and will risk violence to get your hands on it. You wouldn't think of just asking God for it, would you?
- 2 You want something but don't get it. You kill and covet, but you cannot have what you want. You quarrel and fight. You do not have, because you do not ask God.
- 3 And why not? Because you know you'd be asking for what you have no right to. You're spoiled children, each wanting your own way.
- 3 When you ask, you do not receive, because you ask with wrong motives, that you may spend what you get on your pleasures.
- 4 You're cheating on God. If all you want is your own way, flirting with the world every chance you get, you end up enemies of God and his way.
- 4 You adulterous people, don't you know that friendship with the world is hatred toward God? Anyone who chooses to be a friend of the world becomes an enemy of God.
- 5 And do you suppose God doesn't care? The proverb has it that "he's a fiercely jealous lover."

- 5 Or do you think Scripture says without reason that the spirit he caused to live in us envies intensely?
- 6 And what he gives in love is far better than anything else you'll find. It's common knowledge that "God goes against the willful proud; God gives grace to the willing humble."
- 6 But he gives us more grace. That is why Scripture says: "God opposes the proud but gives grace to the humble."
- 7 So let God work his will in you. Yell a loud no to the Devil and watch him scamper.
- 7 Submit yourselves, then, to God. Resist the devil, and he will flee from you.
- 8 Say a quiet yes to God and he'll be there in no time. Quit dabbling in sin. Purify your inner life. Quit playing the field.
- 8 Come near to God and he will come near to you. Wash your hands, you sinners, and purify your hearts, you double- minded.
- 9 Hit bottom, and cry your eyes out. The fun and games are over. Get serious, really serious.
- 9 Grieve, mourn and wail. Change your laughter to mourning and your joy to gloom.
- 10 Get down on your knees before the Master; it's the only way you'll get on your feet.
- 10 Humble yourselves before the Lord, and he will lift you up.
- 11 Don't bad-mouth each other, friends. It's God's Word, his Message, his Royal Rule, that takes a beating in that kind of talk. You're supposed to be honoring the Message, not writing graffiti all over it.
- 11 Brothers, do not slander one another. Anyone who speaks against his brother or judges him speaks against the law and judges it. When you judge the law, you are not keeping it, but sitting in judgment on it.
- 12 God is in charge of deciding human destiny. Who do you think you are to meddle in the destiny of others?
- 12 There is only one Lawgiver and Judge, the one who is able to save and destroy. But you--who are you to judge your neighbor?
- 13 And now I have a word for you who brashly announce, "Today--at the latest, tomorrow--we're off to such and such a city for the year. We're going to start a business and make a lot of money."

- 13 Now listen, you who say, "Today or tomorrow we will go to this or that city, spend a year there, carry on business and make money."
- 14 You don't know the first thing about tomorrow. You're nothing but a wisp of fog, catching a brief bit of sun before disappearing.
- 14 Why, you do not even know what will happen tomorrow. What is your life? You are a mist that appears for a little while and then vanishes.
- 15 Instead, make it a habit to say, "If the Master wills it and we're still alive, we'll do this or that."
- 15 Instead, you ought to say, "If it is the Lord's will, we will live and do this or that."
- 16 As it is, you are full of your grandiose selves. All such vaunting self-importance is evil.
- 16 As it is, you boast and brag. All such boasting is evil.
- 17 In fact, if you know the right thing to do and don't do it, that, for you, is evil.
- 17 Anyone, then, who knows the good he ought to do and doesn't do it, sins.

## James 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 And a final word to you arrogant rich: Take some lessons in lament. You'll need buckets for the tears when the crash comes upon you.
- 1 Now listen, you rich people, weep and wail because of the misery that is coming upon you.
- 2 Your money is corrupt and your fine clothes stink.
- 2 Your wealth has rotted, and moths have eaten your clothes.
- 3 Your greedy luxuries are a cancer in your gut, destroying your life from within. You thought you were piling up wealth. What you've piled up is judgment.
- 3 Your gold and silver are corroded. Their corrosion will testify against you and eat your flesh like fire. You have hoarded wealth in the last days.
- 4 All the workers you've exploited and cheated cry out for judgment. The groans of the workers you used and abused are a roar in the ears of the Master Avenger.

- 4 Look! The wages you failed to pay the workmen who mowed your fields are crying out against you. The cries of the harvesters have reached the ears of the Lord Almighty.
- 5 You've looted the earth and lived it up. But all you'll have to show for it is a fatter than usual corpse.
- 5 You have lived on earth in luxury and self-indulgence. You have fattened yourselves in the day of slaughter.
- 6 In fact, what you've done is condemn and murder perfectly good persons, who stand there and take it.
- 6 You have condemned and murdered innocent men, who were not opposing you.
- 7 Meanwhile, friends, wait patiently for the Master's Arrival. You see farmers do this all the time, waiting for their valuable crops to mature, patiently letting the rain do its slow but sure work.
- 7 Be patient, then, brothers, until the Lord's coming. See how the farmer waits for the land to yield its valuable crop and how patient he is for the autumn and spring rains.
- 8 Be patient like that. Stay steady and strong. The Master could arrive at any time.
- 8 You too, be patient and stand firm, because the Lord's coming is near.
- 9 Friends, don't complain about each other. A far greater complaint could be lodged against you, you know. The Judge is standing just around the corner.
- 9 Don't grumble against each other, brothers, or you will be judged. The Judge is standing at the door!
- 10 Take the old prophets as your mentors. They put up with anything, went through everything, and never once quit, all the time honoring God.
- 10 Brothers, as an example of patience in the face of suffering, take the prophets who spoke in the name of the Lord.
- 11 What a gift life is to those who stay the course! You've heard, of course, of Job's staying power, and you know how God brought it all together for him at the end. That's because God cares, cares right down to the last detail.
- 11 As you know, we consider blessed those who have persevered. You have heard of Job's perseverance and have seen what the Lord finally brought about. The Lord is full of compassion and mercy.

- 12 And since you know that he cares, let your language show it. Don't add words like "I swear to God" to your own words. Don't show your impatience by concocting oaths to hurry up God. Just say yes or no. Just say what is true. That way, your language can't be used against you.
- 12 Above all, my brothers, do not swear--not by heaven or by earth or by anything else. Let your "Yes" be yes, and your "No," no, or you will be condemned.
- 13 Are you hurting? Pray. Do you feel great? Sing.
- 13 Is any one of you in trouble? He should pray. Is anyone happy? Let him sing songs of praise.
- 14 Are you sick? Call the church leaders together to pray and anoint you with oil in the name of the Master.
- 14 Is any one of you sick? He should call the elders of the church to pray over him and anoint him with oil in the name of the Lord.
- 15 Believing-prayer will heal you, and Jesus will put you on your feet. And if you've sinned, you'll be forgiven--healed inside and out.
- 15 And the prayer offered in faith will make the sick person well; the Lord will raise him up. If he has sinned, he will be forgiven.
- 16 Make this your common practice: Confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you can live together whole and healed. The prayer of a person living right with God is something powerful to be reckoned with.
- 16 Therefore confess your sins to each other and pray for each other so that you may be healed. The prayer of a righteous man is powerful and effective.
- 17 Elijah, for instance, human just like us, prayed hard that it wouldn't rain, and it didn't--not a drop for three and a half years.
- 17 Elijah was a man just like us. He prayed earnestly that it would not rain, and it did not rain on the land for three and a half years.
- 18 Then he prayed that it would rain, and it did. The showers came and everything started growing again.
- 18 Again he prayed, and the heavens gave rain, and the earth produced its crops.
- 19 My dear friends, if you know people who have wandered off from God's truth, don't write them off. Go after them. Get them back



- 19 My brothers, if one of you should wander from the truth and someone should bring him back,
- 20 and you will have rescued precious lives from destruction and prevented an epidemic of wandering away from God.
- 20 remember this: Whoever turns a sinner from the error of his way will save him from death and cover over a multitude of sins.